Finale — The Grand Gate & The Unmasking

Who runs it: Lead GM, with helpers stepping in to run the minion fight. **Length:** about 14 minutes plus the transition. **Culprit (DM only): Anton, the Alchemist's Apprentice.** Evidence and suspects: Evidence_and_Suspects.md. Printables: Finale_Print_Kit.pdf (Suspect Board, minion cards, certificates).

Beat	Time	What happens
1 · Transition	rolling, until about 1 min after the bell	Pairs arrive with a Crest and an Evidence Card and start the Suspect Board
2 · The Gate Opens	1 min	The last Crest clicks in and the Gate opens. The Phantom is back
3 · Minion Fight	5 min	Two quick waves of one-hit minions, plus two Bruisers
4 · The Accusation	3 min	The whole group names the culprit from the evidence
5 · The Capture	2 min	The table's plan catches the Phantom. It always works
6 · The Unmasking	2 min	Pull the mask, hear the confession and the famous line
7 · Case Closed	1+ min	Certificates, photos, "how we did it" stories

1 · Transition at the Gate (as each pair arrives)

When a pair walks up with their Crest:

> They slot **Crest #N** into its socket. It glows and the iron wolf's eye lights up.

1. Make it a 15-second moment: the whole room hears it. *"The Library Crest is home! Four to go!"*

2. They lay their **Evidence Card** face up beside the **Suspect Board**, which you flip over when the first pair arrives.

3. Give the early arrivals a job: *"Someone in this castle is faking that ghost. Read the evidence and figure out who."* Encourage them to point and argue, but **don't let them say the final answer yet**: *"Hold that thought for when everyone's here."*

4. **At 15:00, ring the bell.** Any stragglers get their Envelope 4 bailout and arrive within about a minute.

2 · The Gate Opens (read aloud, about 1 min)

Once all five Crests are in:

The five Crests spin in their sockets until their jagged edges lock together into a single glowing ring. The iron wolf's jaws creak open and the Grand Gate swings wide, revealing a vault full of gold, jewels... and a wall of **green fog**.

Out of the fog swoops the Phantom! "NO! That treasure is MINE! I've spent a whole year scaring off every guest! MINIONS... GET THEM!"

From the fog comes a clattering, chittering horde: gear-gremlins, bubbling vial-imps, snapping mini-mimics, and dancing daggers.

3 · Minion Fight (about 5 min)

Keep it fast and loud. No initiative. In each round, **every player** does one thing (go around the table, about 10 seconds each), then the minions act. Helpers can each "run" a cluster of minions and roll for them.

The minion rule

- **Any hit destroys a minion.** No HP to track: if the attack hits, it pops.

- **Area powers wipe out everything they cover.** For example Murray's Sand Blast cone (3 squares), Quasimodo's Culinary Disaster grease, or Johnny's Monster Mash (yes, a dance-off counts).

- **Bruisers take 2 hits** (12 HP). Let the barbarians enjoy smashing them.

- **Nobody goes down.** If a PC drops under 10 HP, the minions "steal a hat" or "tie their shoelaces together" instead of doing damage.

Wave 1 (Round 1): about one minion per player

Minion	AC	Attack	Notes
Gear Gremlin	10	+3, 2 damage (pinch)	Clanks, giggles, steals a gear
Vial Imp	10	+3, 2 acid (spit)	Pops in a puff of purple bubbles
Mini-Mimic	10	+3, 2 damage (chomp)	Looks like a tiny treasure chest with teeth
Dancing Dagger	11	+3, 2 damage (poke)	Clatters to the floor when hit

Wave 2 (Round 2): the Bruisers + 4–6 more minions

Bruiser	AC	HP	Attack
Clockwork Brute (from the Observatory)	12	12	+4, 1d6+2 slam
Mimic Wardrobe (from the Menagerie)	12	12	+4, 1d6+2 bite; on a hit the target is stuck inside until a friend pulls them out (an action)

How it ends (Round 3, or when Wave 2 is down)

The last minion pops. The Phantom shrieks, "This isn't over!", and dives into the fog. You hear running feet. **Very small running feet.** A secret door in the vault wall grinds shut.

Highlight moments to call out (from the sheets):

- Fred's **Net Trap** and Murray's **Sandstorm Shuffle** each pin a Bruiser.

- Scooby and Shaggy run away screaming, and accidentally lead three minions into each other.

- Frank's **Detachable Arm** smacks a minion on its own.

- Wayne's **Swarm of Pups** chases the Vial Imps.

- Drac's **Look Into My Eyes!** sets a Bruiser dancing.

- Griffin is invisible, so the minions keep attacking the empty air where he used to be.

4 · The Accusation (about 3 min)

> The secret door is sealed with a carved wolf's head. A voice echoes from behind it: "You'll never find me! You don't even know who I AM!" The wolf's mouth opens wide, as if waiting for a name.

- Everyone gathers at the **Suspect Board** with the five Evidence Cards.

- Let them argue it out. Each Evidence Card matches one trait on the board.

- **When they name Anton:** the wolf's mouth snaps shut and the door grinds open. *"NO! How did you know?!"*

- **If they name a decoy:** the portrait sticks out its tongue and blows a raspberry, and the voice laughs. Wave **one more** small set of 3 minions out of the walls (1 round), then let them try again. Nudge: *"How many of the five clues does that suspect actually match?"*

The logic (so you can confirm their reasoning):

Evidence	Anton	Tobias	Grisela
E1 Left-handed	Yes	No	Yes
E2 Potions	Yes	No	No
E3 Small boots	Yes	Yes	No
E4 Purple hair	Yes	No	No
E5 Sulfur	Yes	No	No

5 · The Capture (about 2 min)

> The Phantom bursts out of the secret door and makes a run for the treasure!

Ask the table: **"How do you catch him?"** Whatever they plan **works**, so make it a celebration. Good classics:

- Fred's **Net Trap** (it's finally his moment).

- Murray's **Sandstorm Shuffle** wrapping him in bandages.

- Frank's **Massive Shoulders** holding the vault door shut.

- Shaggy and Scooby as "bait" with a Scooby Snack, or Griffin simply... sticking out an invisible foot.

6 · The Unmasking (read aloud, about 2 min)

Invite the player whose plan landed the capture to pull the mask: *"Go on. Pull it."*

> The mask comes off with a rubbery SNAP. Underneath is a short, scowling young man with **purple-stained hair**, smelling powerfully of **sulfur**, his sleeves peppered with tiny burn holes. Everyone in the castle knows that face.
>
> "**Anton!** The Alchemist's apprentice!"
>
> "Ex-apprentice," he snarls. "The old master fired me for weighing bottles two by two! So I built every curse in this castle: the shrieking gargoyle, the clockwork phantom, the mimics, the collapsing ceiling. A year of scaring off every guest so the treasure would be MINE. And I would have gotten away with it, too..."

Pause. Let the table finish the line. (Someone always will: "...if it weren't for you meddling kids!")

> "...if it weren't for you meddling **MONSTERS!**"

7 · Case Closed (1 min or more)

> As the dawn breaks over the Estate, the treasure is returned to the town, Anton is marched off by the constable (still dripping bubbles), and the castle's ghosts, the real ones, settle down for a well-earned rest. Somewhere, very faintly, a vampire says: "I do NOT say 'bleh bleh bleh.'"

- Hand out the **Case Closed certificates** (in the print kit). Each player writes their character's name.
- Go around the room: each pair gets 20 seconds to brag about how they cracked their station.
- Group photo at the Grand Gate.

THE GRA

1 - LIB

5 - ARMORY

FIVE C
ONE

4 - MENAGERIE

Gate half 1/2 - 100% print. Trim margins and tape centre edges.

ND GATE

RARY

RESTS
GATE

2 - LABORATORY

3 - OBSERVATORY

Gate half 2/2 - 100% print. Trim margins and tape centre edges.

Who Is the Phantom?

Show this board when the first pair returns to the Grand Gate.

Suspect 1 · Anton, the Apprentice

- **Writing hand:** Left
- **Daily work:** Potions (his sleeves are always singed)
- **Boots:** Short, small boots
- **Hair:** Stained purple
- **Smells of:** Sulfur

Suspect 2 · Master Tobias, the Clockmaker

- **Writing hand:** Right
- **Daily work:** Clocks and gears
- **Boots:** Short, small boots
- **Hair:** Snow-white
- **Smells of:** Machine oil

Suspect 3 · Grisela, the Groundskeeper

- **Writing hand:** Left
- **Daily work:** Gardens and graves
- **Boots:** Huge, giant boots
- **Hair:** Iron-grey
- **Smells of:** Compost

How to Solve It

Lay each **Evidence Card** you won beside the board. Every card describes **one thing about the Phantom**. Only one suspect matches **all five**.

When the Phantom hides behind the wolf door, say that suspect's name!

Spare Evidence Cards

Use only if a station's evidence card is missing; these duplicate E1-E5.

E1 · The Borrowed Book (Library)

Tucked behind Barov's plinth: *Spooky Mechanisms for Beginners*, long overdue. The borrower's signature is smeared from right to left, the way a **left-handed** writer drags their hand through wet ink.

E2 · The Singed Sleeve (Lab)

Under the workbench: a torn lab-coat sleeve peppered with tiny burn holes from splashed quicksilver. Whoever wore it **mixed potions every day**.

E3 · The Oily Footprints (Observatory)

Gear-oil footprints lead behind the great clock: **small** boots, barely bigger than a kid's.

E4 · The Mimic's Snack (Menagerie)

Stuck between the mimic's needle teeth: a tuft of hair stained bright **purple**.

E5 · The Stinky Glove (Armory)

The pups drag up a glove along with the crest. It reeks of rotten eggs: **sulfur**.

Cut apart. Give evidence at its station reward or replace a missing card at the Gate.

Minion and Bruiser References

DM / helpers only. Give each helper a cluster. Every player acts once each round.

Minion Rule (read first)

- **Any hit destroys a minion.** No HP tracking.
- **Area powers** pop every minion they cover.
- **Bruisers** take 2 hits (12 HP).
- **Nobody goes down:** under 10 HP, minions steal hats and tie shoelaces instead of doing damage.
- **Each round:** every player acts once, then the minions act.

Gear Gremlin · Vial Imp · Mini-Mimic

AC 10 · 1 hit · Attack +3, 2 damage

- Gear Gremlin: clanks, giggles, steals a gear.
- Vial Imp: spits acid, pops in purple bubbles.
- Mini-Mimic: a tiny treasure chest with teeth.

Dancing Dagger

AC 11 · 1 hit · Attack +3, 2 damage Pokes, twirls, clatters to the floor when hit.

Clockwork Brute (Bruiser)

AC 12 · 12 HP (about 2 hits) · Slam +4, 1d6+2 Arrives in Wave 2. Ticks loudly. Great for Net Trap, Sandstorm Shuffle or a Look Into My Eyes! dance.

Mimic Wardrobe (Bruiser)

AC 12 · 12 HP (about 2 hits) · Bite +4, 1d6+2 On a hit, the target is stuck inside until a friend uses an action to pull them out.

Wave Plan

- **Round 1:** about one minion per player (mixed types).
- **Round 2:** both Bruisers + 4–6 minions.
- **Round 3:** mop up, then the Phantom flees.
- **Wrong accusation later:** 3 more minions, 1 round.

Keep combat brisk; use the script for waves, capture and unmasking.

Case Closed Certificates

Keep hidden until after the unmasking. Four per page; twelve certificates total.

CASE CLOSED

The Von Zarovich Estate · Halloween

This certifies that

_____

recovered a Crest, opened the Grand Gate, and helped unmask **Anton the Apprentice**, the Phantom of the Estate.

"...if it weren't for you meddling MONSTERS!"

CASE CLOSED

The Von Zarovich Estate · Halloween

This certifies that

_____

recovered a Crest, opened the Grand Gate, and helped unmask **Anton the Apprentice**, the Phantom of the Estate.

"...if it weren't for you meddling MONSTERS!"

CASE CLOSED

The Von Zarovich Estate · Halloween

This certifies that

_____

recovered a Crest, opened the Grand Gate, and helped unmask **Anton the Apprentice**, the Phantom of the Estate.

"...if it weren't for you meddling MONSTERS!"

CASE CLOSED

The Von Zarovich Estate · Halloween

This certifies that

_____

recovered a Crest, opened the Grand Gate, and helped unmask **Anton the Apprentice**, the Phantom of the Estate.

"...if it weren't for you meddling MONSTERS!"

Award after the case is solved.

Case Closed Certificates

Keep hidden until after the unmasking. Four per page; twelve certificates total.

CASE CLOSED

The Von Zarovich Estate · Halloween

This certifies that

_____

recovered a Crest, opened the Grand Gate, and helped unmask **Anton the Apprentice**, the Phantom of the Estate.

"...if it weren't for you meddling MONSTERS!"

CASE CLOSED

The Von Zarovich Estate · Halloween

This certifies that

_____

recovered a Crest, opened the Grand Gate, and helped unmask **Anton the Apprentice**, the Phantom of the Estate.

"...if it weren't for you meddling MONSTERS!"

CASE CLOSED

The Von Zarovich Estate · Halloween

This certifies that

_____

recovered a Crest, opened the Grand Gate, and helped unmask **Anton the Apprentice**, the Phantom of the Estate.

"...if it weren't for you meddling MONSTERS!"

CASE CLOSED

The Von Zarovich Estate · Halloween

This certifies that

_____

recovered a Crest, opened the Grand Gate, and helped unmask **Anton the Apprentice**, the Phantom of the Estate.

"...if it weren't for you meddling MONSTERS!"

Award after the case is solved.

Case Closed Certificates

Keep hidden until after the unmasking. Four per page; twelve certificates total.

CASE CLOSED

The Von Zarovich Estate · Halloween

This certifies that

_____

recovered a Crest, opened the Grand Gate, and helped unmask **Anton the Apprentice**, the Phantom of the Estate.

"...if it weren't for you meddling MONSTERS!"

CASE CLOSED

The Von Zarovich Estate · Halloween

This certifies that

_____

recovered a Crest, opened the Grand Gate, and helped unmask **Anton the Apprentice**, the Phantom of the Estate.

"...if it weren't for you meddling MONSTERS!"

CASE CLOSED

The Von Zarovich Estate · Halloween

This certifies that

_____

recovered a Crest, opened the Grand Gate, and helped unmask **Anton the Apprentice**, the Phantom of the Estate.

"...if it weren't for you meddling MONSTERS!"

CASE CLOSED

The Von Zarovich Estate · Halloween

This certifies that

_____

recovered a Crest, opened the Grand Gate, and helped unmask **Anton the Apprentice**, the Phantom of the Estate.

"...if it weren't for you meddling MONSTERS!"

Award after the case is solved.